Hazel surveys the area: without flight, the cleric sees that the only other way down is the waterfall, which plunges several hundred feet down.

The Party decides to split up. Wang Lei, Mason, Vilde and Thaisha take to the skies, with the druid carrying Hazel. They will do a quick survey of the city as the rest of the Party drops down, taking the waterfall. The Expedition will then reconvene on the near bank, consolidating before making their moves into the city.

Realizing that Duo and Princess will not be able to make the journey, Hazel hops up to the owlbear. "Stay safe, big guy," the rabbitfolk sends the beast into the jungle, directing him to keep out of sight and stay on the ridgeline. "And take care of the dinosaur."

The lumbering owlbear bends low, nudging his beak softly into the cleric.

Vilde clacks at Princess as well, wishing them both to stay safe. Princess screeches in response, as the pair head off into the jungle.

Thaisha wildshapes to a falcon, picking up the harregon. Wang Lei, you and Mason grab the side of your cloaks and dive off the waterfall, as the feathers ruffle and pull you up into the sky.

Vilde, you squeeze the hilts of the scimitars. Golden, glowing wings explode from your back. With a powerful whoosh, you shoot into the sky.

### Wisdom (Perception) Check

On a **DC 15** check, the Party sees the Red Wizards' walled compound and the amphitheater. They see about forty or fifty Red Wizards in the compound, and a massive tyrannosaurus rex sleeping in the amphitheater. They also find a small staircase leading into the city.

On a **DC 20** check, the Party uses Celestial inscriptions to find the shrines. They find four of them: (1) "Obo'laka teaches us to tread warily and stay in the light," (2) "Kubazan urges us to tread without fear and to give back as much as we take," (3) "Papazotl teaches us to bow before no one," and (4) "Shagambi teaches us to fight evil with honor."

## Untapped and Unbowed

Weaving arcana through the air, Ariadne casts *Featherfall*. Radiant threads of shimmering golden light spring from her fingertips, binding Salazar, Wukong, Raphael, Claptrap, and Vorn together in a web of magical grace. In a blinding flash, the golden filaments weave tight, blossoming overhead into a massive, luminous parachute. Together, the six of them charge toward the roaring crest of the waterfall and hurl themselves off the precipice, plunging into the sprawling expanse of the city below.

The six of you fall. Instead of a rapid descent, you glide harmlessly, slowly along the roaring waterfall. You all see, in the distance, a small flooded building. Instead of a normal roof, in its place is a giant heron sculpture. An ornate, carved long-legged bird with a needle-like beak spreads its wings triumphantly to form the sloping cover of the shrine.

With nothing but a splash, Ariadne, Salazar, Wukong, Raphael, Claptrap and Vorn you land in the river. Surging currents begin pulling you downstream.

Give me a Strength saving throw.



As the raging turbulence of the river slams into the Party, Salazar is pulled downstream. Using his quick thinking, Wukong snaps his tail around and spreads himself out, grabbing Ariadne, Raphael and Claptrap. Vorn steadies himself easily, his weight a boon in the current. The five of them form a circle to steady themselves, swimming downstream together in pursuit of Salazar.

Struggling not to drown, the wizard Salazar tumbles unceremoniously towards Papazotl's Shrine. When he

### Raging River

When swimming without a swim speed, all water tiles are difficult terrain. In addition, the Player has to make Constitution saving throw for every hour of swimming, starting at DC 11.

Entering a raging river, the Party is caught in the currents. They must succeed on a DC **15** Strength saving throw or be swept up in the current. If swept up in the current, the current moves them 10 feet per turn in the direction of the flow. On a success, they tread water. When moving in the river, the PCs need to make a DC 20 Strength (Athletics) check. If they are moving in the direction of the current, the DC drops by 5.

A creature can hold their breath for a number of minutes equal to 1 + their CON modifier. When a creature runs out of breath, it can survive a number of rounds equal to their CON modifier. At the start of its next turn, it drop to 0 hit points and is dying. It cannot regain hit points or be stabilised until it can breathe again. In addition, a creature that takes damage while holding their breath must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw or lose 1 minute of air.

A creature without a swim speed makes melee weapon attacks with disadvantage, unless the weapon is a dagger, javelin, shortsword, spear or trident. Ranged weapon attacks automatically miss a target beyond the weapon's normal range.

## Giant Crocodile

*Huge Beast, unaligned*

**Armor Class** 14 (Natural Armor)
**Hit Points** 85 (9d12 + 27)
**Speed** 30 ft., swim 50 ft.

| STR | DEX | CON | INT | WIS | CHA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 21 (+5) | 9 (-1) | 17 (+3) | 2 (-4) | 10 (+0) | 7 (-2) |

**Skills** Stealth +5
**Senses** Passive Perception 10
**Languages** None
**Initiative Bonus** -1

### Traits

**Hold Breath.** The crocodile can hold its breath for 1 hour.

### Actions

**Multiattack.** The giant crocodile makes two attacks: one **Bite**, and one **Tail**.

***Bite***. *Melee Attack Roll*: +8, reach 5 ft. *Hit*: 21 (3d10 + 5) Piercing damage. In addition, if the target is a Large or smaller creature, the creature is Grappled.

***Tail***. *Melee Attack Roll*: +8, reach 10 ft. *Hit*: 18 (3d8 + 5) Bludgeoning damage. In addition, if the target is a Large or smaller creature, the creature is Prone.

finally regains control, he finds himself in a muddy bed. Giant crocodiles wallow in the river, from which rises a walled ruin. Two columns flank the entrance, carved with images of a long-legged bird with a needle-like beak. At the building's front, slimy steps ascend to an entry arch.

As Wukong, Raphael, Ariadne, Claptrap and Vorn arrive, they spot Salazar at the front of the shrine. Giant crocodiles attack, trying to eat the hapless wizard.

Wukong dives towards his friend, but the weight of his armour is far too much. The paladin is at the mercy of the tide as the river knocks him downstream.

Salazar kicks with all his might, surging upwards with tremendous strength. As the wizard breaks the surface of the water, he casts *Misty Step,* appearing at the top of one of the lichen-covered perimeter walls of the shrine. He regains his footing, almost falling over. He steadies himself as he unleashes a *Fire Bolt,* searing one of the crocodiles.

At the back of the shrine, Vorn is swept downstream. Raphael directs Claptrap to hold on tight to one of the walls as the sorcerer casts *Misty Step*, getting out of the



raging river. As he reappears on the perimeter wall, he leaps forwards and weaves magic in the air. A ball of lightning materialises in his palms, darting towards the already injured crocodile as the sorcerer casts *Sorcerous Burst*.

Ariadne soars elegantly onto the edge, pulling herself up onto the moss-covered ledge easily. With a quick incantation, she fires a *Guiding Bolt* at the giant crocodile. Bested by the powerful arcana displayed, the injured giant crocodile scurries off into the depths to lick its wounds.

Having been pulled downstream, Wukong stabilizes himself by enlarging his *Jingubang*. The simian jams the enlarged quarterstaff in between the perimeter wall and the wall of the shrine. He clambers onto the ledge and tries to leap to where Salazar is, only to slip on the slippery moss. The wizard tries to grab the paladin, but he is not strong enough. The pair go overboard, landing in the water once more.

Salazar casts *Misty Step* again, reappearing on the ledge just in front of the shrine. He tries to peek into the shrine to make sure it is safe, but cannot see beyond a few feet in the door. Deciding to make a leap of faith, the wizard jumps, hoping to clear the distance of the water and land on the steps of the shrine.

Wukong watches as the brave wizard fall short, sinking like a stone into the water just five feet away from safety. Murky shapes swirl under the surface as the giant crocodiles strike.

The wizard dodges the snapping jaws of the giant crocodile, but was too slow and struck by the tail as the crocodile whips around. He sees the second crocodile rocket towards him and casts *Shield* just in time to avoid its ferocious bite.

Raphael jumps from one ledge to the other, sprinting towards the front of the shrine. As the giant crocodiles try to get their lunch below the surface, the sorcerer sees water churn chaotically and realizes that Salazar must be fighting for his life underwater.

Ariadne follows Raphael's lead, jumping onto the front wall and rolling along the narrow ledge to leap forward again. She sees Raphael in front, and stop abruptly in her tracks.

The stumbling Vorn slams his fists into the walls, securing himself. He tries to get up on the wall, but is too heavy.

Wukong dives towards Salazar, seeing that the wizard is on the cusp of becoming fish food. His eyes glow golden as he casts *Guiding Bolt*. A blinding blast of light explodes from the *Jingubang*'s end, striking one of the crocodiles and lighting it on fire.

Seizing the opportunity provided by the paladin, Salazar casts *Misty Step* for the third time. He materializes in a cloud of mist on the slimy steps of the shrine.

> Ascending through the slimy steps into the shrine, Salazar you find that moss and lichen have overtaken this space. It clings to stonework throughout this hall. The mosaic floor beneath you depicts a tall bird with a long and pointy beak, much like a stork or a heron. To your right, is a bronze wall with a Celestial inscription, which you cannot read.
>
> Opposite, set into the far wall, is an open set of heavy, stone doors. An empty pedestal stands in the middle of the chamber past the stone doors. Six statues face it from alcoves on the wall. They depict bare-chested humans, with the heads of different animals. You see a lizard, a jaguar, a lobster, a toucan, a bat and a frog.

Salazar calls out to the Party: "It's safe here! Get in the shrine!" Raphael and Ariadne exchange looks, unsure if the wizard properly checked the room.

Raphael leaps to the next ledge, heading to the front of the shrine. Seeing blood and shadows lurking in the water, Raphael focuses on the task of repelling the crocodiles. The sorcerer produces a *Muter's Gem* from his robes, crushing it in his hands. Raphael conjures a blistering ball of fire, blossoming with a low roar. As the magic of the *Muter's Gem* takes effect, the ball of energy is transmuted into a crackling ball of lightning, streaking into the center of the river. Galvanic power blasts outwards, electrifying both giant crocodiles and sending them scampering away into the depths.

Raphael, Ariadne, Wukong, Claptrap and Vorn take their time wading against the river, finally entering the shrine as Hazel, Thaisha, Vilde, Wang Lei and Mason arrive.

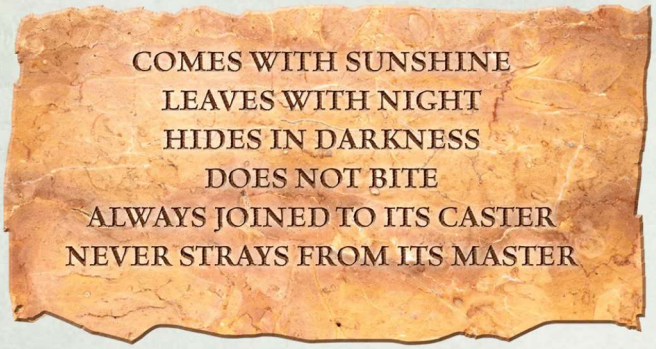
Wukong leads the investigation. Activating his *Truesight,* he scans the antechamber and sees that there are no illusions active.

> The Party sees that there is a crawlspace behind the bat statue.

Hazel crawls in as the Party looks around. Outside, Vilde suggests that they each take a look at one of the statues, prompting the Party to fan out.

Hazel enters the hidden room, seeing a strange grid etched into the far wall of this stone cell. She realizes that it is a puzzle key of some kind, but intuits that the puzzle cube has likely been taken since the entire chamber is open.

As the Party investigates the statues, Salazar sees a riddle inscribed in the base of the empty pedestal.




The wizard reads it aloud. Hazel crawls out of the secret passage as Salazar finishes the riddle, and nonchalantly replies "oh, it's a shadow."

Ariadne puts the solution together, telling the Party that it is likely that the shadow is used to open the crawlspace and find a key of some kind.

As Ariadne finishes her explanation, Salazar says, "oh, it's a shadow." He turns to the Party, then asks, "And what would we do with the shadow?"

The Party rolls their eyes at the wizard as Ariadne repeats her explanation.

Remembering the inscription on the bronze wall outside, Vilde directs Wukong to translate it for the Party. The simian reads out the following inscription:

> "Papazotl teaches us to bow to no one. He reflects the apocryphal commandment to live close to the ground and reject artificial hierarchies. Urban structures demand submission to kings, laws, and social contracts. These are traps that shackle mortal freedom. Papazotl represents the rigid, ancient timber that snaps before it bends, teaching acolytes that their only allegiance is to the wild law of nature and their own authentic spirit."

"That's Saleander's teachings," Hazel realises. She thinks back to her *Grimoire,* realizing that there are no mentions of a Papazotl or heron-like figure. The cleric wonders what that means, but explains that "every acolyte has their own interpretation of the text."

The Party discusses where to head to next.

"Should we split up?" Mason asks.

"What?" Wang Lei replies. "Why?"

"We can fly," Mason points out. "We can do two shrines simultaneously."

"I don't think we should split up," Thaisha disagrees. "It's dangerous."

"We can go one round around the city," Wang Lei suggests. "Starting from the Royal Palace. If it is a threat, we can go with a full squad."

"Why are we going to the palace?" Vilde asks. "The Hags and the Devourer are at the obelisk."

"There might be people at the Palace," Raphael suggests. "We can storm it first, and then split up after that - "

"Why don't we just clear the shrines?" Mason asks, clearly confused. "That's what we need to do to destroy the Devourer, right? What's at the Palace that we need to do, now, that is more pressing than the Devourer?"

"No, no, we're going to have to go through the Palace anyway," Wang Lei explains.

"Well, technically, we can fly over it," Vilde says. "And it would be good to clear the area so those who can't fly can still pass through it, safely."

"Right, but there's a shrine on the western side of the city, which we should just head to now," Mason points out.

"We can get to that later - "

"But we can split up, and get to that now - "

**Wisdom (Insight) Check**
On a failed **DC 15** check, Wang Lei senses a lot of animosity from Mason directed towards him specifically.

"We should definitely stick together," Thaisha interjects. "But, time is of the essence and light is dying. We should head towards the shrine where Salazar had a vision -"

Hazel, who has been quiet thus far, zones in on the squire. She sees that Mason is acting rather aggressively towards his mentor, almost as if he feels indignant at what the knight is suggesting. She interrupts the conversation, asking the Party to calm down. She points out that nobody has absolute knowledge on the lost city, and explains that it would be beneficial if she ritually casts *Augury* to see if Saleander could provide some advice. She also shares her ability to cast *Water Walk,* which would allow up to ten people to traverse the raging river, with the caveat that it lasts an hour. She suggests that those without the ability to fly be those receiving the spell, should they elect to split up. Hazel also passes the *Gloves of Healing* to Claptrap.

Vilde, having already wanted to give the Ring to her sister, takes this opportunity to pass the *Ring of Water Walking* to Ariadne. "That's what sisters do," The rogue smiles.

"Oh, okay!" Ariadne produces a gold piece, offering it to Vilde in response.

"Oh, it's okay," Vilde replies. "That's chump change."

### Wisdom (Insight) Check

On a successful DC **20** check, Vilde sees that Ariadne is crestfallen that the gold piece, which was a significant amount of money for her, was rejected because it was too little.

Hazel collects the animal heads of the six marble statues, smashing it on the ground around the pedestal. As dust kicks up from the shattered marble, it forms the shape of a horned rabbit. Realizing that she will need to sacrifice the *Figurine of Wondrous Power* she collected from so long ago, the cleric produces it and begins gnawing at the wooden figurine.

### Wisdom (Religion) Check

On a successful DC **15** check, Hazel realizes that the effects of the *Hallow* spell are active, with prejudice against the Undead.

On a successful DC **20** check, Hazel senses the other *Hallow* spells active around town and can twist them to her desire. She can bind an additional effect of any type to each shrine.

On a successful DC **25** check, Hazel can cast *Commune* ritually.

Pulled towards the pedestal, you climb onto it as you continue eating your figurine. As you do, you feel roiling divine energy. Air vibrates around you. Your eyes roll back into the back of your head as you begin to shake.

Light fills the room. Esctasy floods your body. You see now that you are in hallowed ground. Not just in the metaphorical sense, but the literal sense. You detect the effects of the *Hallow* spell.

You don't just detect it here. You detect eight other points, distributed throughout the city. Connected to them like strands in a mycelium network, through all that is dead and decaying in the ground, you feel raw arcana swirling, for the first time in centuries in these shrines. Like stagnant water behind a dam. Untapped, ungoverned, unsculpted.

Hazel directs the energy to create Darkness around the pedestals, hoping that it would obfuscate those who are trying to collect the puzzle cubes.

As you reawaken the divine protections that have guarded these shrines for centuries, you level up.

As the esctasy fades from your body, and your eyes roll back to the front of your head, Hazel you come to the realization that you can cast *Commune* as a ritual in a shrine and speak directly to Saleander.

"I've received otherworldly visions," Hazel says. "I need to commune with her."

"Did you... get fatter?" Vilde asks. "You look a little fatter."

"Yes, I am," Hazel replies, patting her stomach. "Thank you."

"Okay, we can split the Party," Vilde says, slowly. "Rush the shrines, use it to gain entry to the Tomb." She pauses, thinking about Ras Nsi and his involvement in the city.

"Yeah, I guess we can skip the palace," Raphael continues from the previous conversation. "There are a lot of parties here in the city that do not organically belong here. There are the Red Wizards, and, more importantly, the other Expeditions who came before us. Where are they?" He pauses, thinking. "And then there's Ras Nsi, and the Hags. If the Hags are already at the obelisk, then it is likely that Ras Nsi might be at the Palace."

"If we're splitting up, then the half of the Party flying should just hit the shrines," Wang Lei says. "We need all nine cubes to enter the Tomb, right?" As the paladin asks the question, he realizes that Papazotl's puzzle cube has already been taken by someone else. "Whoever took Papazotl's cube would likely also need all nine," the paladin deduces. "Which means getting the cubes isn't enough."

"Yeah," Raphael agrees. "It's probably the Red Wizards who have the cube. The way I see it, it's a race. We collect as many as we can, and we take what's left by force from the Red Wizards."

"It could be anybody collecting the cubes," Wang Lei points out. "Maybe even the 51st."

"Impossible," Raphael says. "They left later than us, and we retraced our steps towards Tamoachan. There's no way Taylor has arrived." The sorcerer pours over the map, contemplating. "We can cut the city up into areas," He suggested finally. "Clear it, area by area."

"Makes sense," Vilde says. "We clear the western part of the city, and then cross over to the eastern part. The Flying Party can take this," the rogue taps the shrine overlooking the lava rift, "while the Water Party can go here," as she points out the closest shrine to their current location.

"We can circle around the Palace on our way there," Wang Lei reminds the Party. "Do another round of scouting."

"If we're going to split up," Thaisha says, looking quickly at Mason then Wang Lei, "which, I am not an advocate for, we should still remain relatively close to one another. If we end up on opposite sides of the city, we cannot call for each other."

"I think we can handle ourselves," Vilde assures. "But, I think you're right. We can go this shrine instead." The rogue taps the shrine just at the edge of the Royal Palace. "We can meet up and rendezvous after."

Wang Lei eyes the squire, making a mental note to find out more about his behaviour.

"Should I learn *Fly* now?" Salazar asks.

"Okay, no, we're leaving, bye," Vilde says quickly, turning to Raphael. "Please take care of Ariadne."

The sorcerer nods, as they both ignore the wizard.

Deciding to wait for Hazel, the Party takes a short rest. Salazar rests as Vilde whips up a quick snack; Wang Lei and Raphael does some light reading.





Hazel, as you cast *Commune,* you see a vision. Rain. A downpour that never ends. A storm that threatens to drown the very world. A beautiful woman with pointed ears and glowing orange tattoos rides a horse in this storm. Her hair is a brilliant burst of fire.

Racing through the jungle, the *Grimoire* in one hand, you see she mutters soft apologies under her breath. "I'm sorry, my goddess," She whispers. "I've failed you."

Over head, a massive bird towers over you. It moves so quickly that you barely catch a glimpse of the beautifully vibrant purple and blue plumage. The monstrosity dives down and slams with incredible power in front of the wizard. Both of its heads wheel around at the fire genasi and with a roar, an iridescent breath blasts out and engulfs both rider and mount, disintegrating both.

The book that you've grown so familiar with drops unceremoniously into the dirt as the soft patter of rain continues. As you look around, you realize that this is the exact site you will bury your dog Sally centuries from now. This is where you will find the *Grimoire of Saleander.*

Hazel steps forward, picking up the book as the monstrosity soars into the sky.

"That was Fyra'Rai," Saleander explains. "She was you, before you. A wizard in service of me. They were supposed to kill Zephyr, the Tempest that Drowns the World, but... as you can see..." Her voice trails off.

Having never met Saleander before, Hazel is struck mute, in awe of her goddess.

"I'm sorry, dear rabbit," the goddess continues. "I did not mean for you to bear such immense responsibility."

The harregon steels herself, gritting her teeth. She resists the urge to chew her paw pads. "What do I have

to do?"

"The War of Axe and Vine was a terrible mistake," Saleander explains. "A wrong I am struggling to make right. That's why I've set you on this path. You must right my wrongs. The trickster spirits... I did not expect their ambitions to grow to such proportions. I know it is simple to think of us gods as something infallible, but divinity is a two-way street. The desires of our worshippers have as much impact on us as the desires of us on you. The people of Raya... they were looking for any excuse to shed blood. And my trickster spirits listened."

Hazel bows down, reaching out slowly to feel the fungril tendrils. The feelers jostle softly as the goddess bends down, reaching her long fingers to caress the rabbitfolk's fur.

"I need strength," the cleric pleads. "I need means to defend myself in this wasteland of death and corpses. I cannot do this just by myself."





"Of course, my dear rabbit," Saleander says, her voice soft and encouraging. "You must restore the balance," She urges. "Purge the sins of my trickster spirits. You must kill Ras Nsi, who has been alive for far too long. And the Death Rider Engine - you must stop it from melting down. Its effects have been animating the dead throughout the continent for centuries."

> As she speaks, you see a tiny little almiraj appear. It is a small little furry brown rabbit, with a protruding horn. You recognize this - it is the form your *Spirit Guardians* take.

Seizing the benefits of the *Commune* spell, Hazel clarifies the doubt that has been circulating her mind since her encounter with Benedict. "Am I your head acolyte? Am I free to interpret your teachings?"

As Saleander nods, Hazel understands her purpose: she is not only here to cleanse the sins of the trickster spirits that came before, but also to define and spread the new religion for her.

"May you grant me permission to smite those who worship you in false faith?" Hazel asks, her head still bowed.

"Yes, my dear rabbit," Saleander replies. "We watch over the line between life and death. You are to send those who resist death, or desecrate the dead's rest to me as early as possible."

"Will I see you again?" The cleric asks, raising her head finally.

Saleander shrugs. "That depends on you, my dear."

As the *Commune* spell ends, Hazel is imbued with a renewed drive. "Okay," the cleric declares. "What's the plan?"

## Raiders of the Lost City

Hazel, Thaisha, Mason, Wang Lei and Vilde take to the skies while Raphael, Salazar, Wukong, Vorn, Claptrap and Ariadne head towards the other flooded shrine close-by on foot.

> As all of you take off, all of you see a glint of light from a sunken bell tower somewhere to your right, in the east of the city.

"Change of plans!" Wang Lei shouts over the roar of the wind. "Somebody's tracking us. We should take him out!"

Mason, Wang Lei and Vilde bank right, turning directly towards the glint. Hazel, riding Thaisha, casts *Invisibility*. The rabbitfolk and the falcon vanish from sight as they also dive towards the flooded bell tower.

With the natural grace of an elf, Vilde performs evasive maneuvers. Rather than carving a straight path, the rogue treats the open sky as her personal stage. Her brown-and-black wings, courtesy of *Dawn* and *Dusk*, move with but a flick of her shoulders as she spins around in a mesmerising spiral, zeroed in on the bell tower.

A violent, concussive crack cuts through the howl of the wind, as if thunder itself had been bottled and released. A flash of white light burst from the weapon's open mouth, followed by wisps of smoke in a snarl of sulphur. Vilde jerks backwards, as if she was struck by an invisible fist. Blood blooms across her chest, coating her leather armour.

A second clap of thunder echoes throughout the sunken city as another projectile strikes the rogue. Through sheer force of will, Vilde hangs on to her scimitars and keeps herself airborne. Slowed by the strikes, the rogue decides to hide behind buildings on the ground. Vilde plummets at neck-breaking speeds, seeking cover. Her wings vanish as the rogue lunges behind a tree, hoping to stay out of sight.

**Dexterity (Stealth) Check**
On a failed contested check, the unseen attacker spots Vilde's hiding location, and will attempt to pierce through the tree.

The attacker unleashes another barrage of fire, burying his shot deep in the bark of the tree. Failing to pierce the tree trunk, Vilde is unaffected. Up close, she can see now that instead of an arrow, metal pellets of some kind are used as the ammunition.

"I wanted a tongue piercing!" The rogue peeks her head out from behind the tree, yelling at the top of her voice. "You missed!"

Another shot finds its mark in the tree, prompting the rogue to withdraw her head back into cover. Catching her breath, she scurries out from behind the tree, dashing forward towards the bell tower and lunging for cover behind a small limestone building.

**Dexterity (Stealth) Check**
On a failed contested check, the unseen attacker spots Vilde's hiding location again, and will attempt to pierce through the tree.

Against the barrage of fire, there is a sudden reprieve. Wang Lei, still flying and having closed distance, can now see their assailants: in the bell tower, a small boy and a man using a unique, elongated longarm. The pair fiddle with the weapon, a sight the paladin is familiar with having trained with crossbows earlier in his life. The weapon is jammed.

Seizing the lull, Vilde sneaks forward. She draws *Sprezzatura,* taking aim. "Let's try this," the rogue says. She lets loose an energy arrow, powered by magic from the Feywild. It goes wide. "Okay, forget it!"

**Dexterity (Stealth) Check**
On a successful contested check, the unseen attacker does not spot Vilde's hiding. She disappears into the urban sprawl.

Wang Lei drops closer to the ground, stopping at the same level as the attacker. He speeds forward with a predatory agility, leaving behind a wake of raven feathers.

The attacker fires again, this time directed at Wang Lei. On his belt, *The Child's Teddy Bear* glows in warning, prompting the paladin to twist in mid-air. The first strike hits nothing more than cold air. Before he can celebrate, the second sinks deep in his shoulder, drawing blood.

As the Party closes in, there is yet another respite in the rhythm of fire. The weapon jams again as the pair of attackers scramble to fix the longarm. In panic, the attacker fires another two shots, which go wide.

Taking advantage of the distance, the attacker fires two more. Even though one of the bullets find its mark, it barely slows the paladin down as the Party barrels at full speeds towards their target.

"Guess who?" Vilde's voice rings out from beside the attacker as a roaring, gleaming golden dragon bursts



forth from her scimitars, pulverising the attacker.

> The sheer magnitude of the magic crackles along the blades, kindling something ancient and powerful deep in your chest As an intoxicating surge of a higher tier of strength runs through both of your arms, Vilde, you level up.

"Mummy's home!" She announces as she swings *Dawn* down at the prone attacker.

He rolls away, dodging the scimitar. "How did you get here so fast?!" As he shuffles to his feet, Vilde swings *Dusk* in a savage upward arc, slashing him from navel to neck.

Stumbling backwards, his eyes widen in shock. He turns to the little boy, shouting "Run, Orym, run!"

A brilliant jolt of realization passes through Vilde as she recognizes the boy: not only was he the one who ambushed them at the goblin village of Yellyark, he was also the boy who had tried to pick her pocket so long ago at the Church of Caishenye.

"Yeah, no, not today," Vilde's *Spider Gauntlets* whir to life as she fires *Web* at the pair. Caught momentarily, the pair tries to get the webbing off them.

"My friends are waiting on the other side," Vilde threatens. "You can jump out and die, or you can stay here and tell me why you are trying to kill me."

**Charisma (Deception) Check**
On a successful contested check, the unseen attacker believes Vilde's claim.

"Yeah?" The attacker replies coolly. "You better kill me, like you did my brother!"

**Wisdom (Insight) Check**
On a successful DC **20** check, Vilde sees the similarity in the brown eyes. Her suspicions are confirmed: this is the surviving brother of Locke Lamora, the Xanathar Network thief the Party had executed previously in the Church.

"I remember him vaguely," Vilde lies. "Number one, I didn't kill him; I tried to save him! He had a bomb in his wheelchair, and it exploded - "

"The Sewn Sisters shown me everything!" He screams. "I know what happened in the hideout!"

"Please," Vilde tries. "They're Hags! Would you rather believe them, or me, an upstanding citizen - "

The attacker draws his pepperbox pistol, firing at the rogue. Vilde is struck by a bullet, but lunges forward

regardless. She grabs the pistol, forcing it upwards as the other shots strike the bell in the bell tower. In pure desperation, the man turns around and shoves Orym out of the bell tower and into the raging river below.

"Okay, enough," Vilde breaks his grip on the pistol, gaining control. "We'll talk later." She whips the butt of the pepperbox into his head, knocking him out.

As the confrontation ends, Wang Lei, Mason, Thaisha and Hazel enter the bell tower gracefully.

"Now, now, what is this?" The paladin picks up the longarm - *Wrath* - and inspects it. Requiring two hands to wield, Wang Lei learns that the weapon has incredible range and stopping power, but can only take one ammunition at a time.



Vilde inspects the pepperbox pistol *Vengeance*. With a rotating chamber which could store six charges at a time, the rogue finds a thinner, more refined pistol.

"What happened here?" Hazel surveys the area.

**Intelligence (Investigation) Check**

On a successful DC **15** check, Hazel sees that this bell tower, formerly used as signal towers throughout Raya, has been repurposed into a base of some sort.

On a successful DC **20** check, Hazel sees a map with other bell towers marked as potential vantage points. She deduces that the assailant likely had a plan to move in between the towers so as to harrass people on the ground.

On a successful DC **25** check, Hazel also finds letters to the Sewn Sisters, in particular Widow Groat, who provided occult knowledge that facilitated his experimentation with alchemical components and rare metals. Having unlocked the secrets of controlled explosive force, this is the first man to have created, and deftly wield, the world's first firearms.

Hazel shares this with the group as the Party begins wrapping up their investigation. Hearing that the firearms were constructed as part of an occult deal, Wang Lei reaches out to his patron quietly in the hopes of more power.

**Wisdom (Insight) Check**

On a successful DC **15** check, Wang Lei feels the Child's reticence. He comes to the conclusion that the Gray Baby is reluctant to impart more power or knowledge, in particular with a task outstanding.

## Live Deliciously

Raphael, Salazar, Wukong, Vorn, Claptrap and Ariadne arrive at a flooded, swampy shrine. The ruined edifice, shaped like an arrowhead, squats in the muddy water. Bushes and trees grow from its roof. At the pointed front of the building, steps ascend to a stone door caked in slime.

Salazar inspects the door, seeing that it is not magically secured.

"*Nangnang teaches us to serve only ourselves*," Wukong recites, translating the inscription above the shrine.

Vorn punches the door, but fails to open it.

"Okay, let's try something a little bit more graceful, shall we?" Ariadne offers. Producing a set of *Thieves' Tools,* she offers it to Wukong. "If you wouldn't mind?"

The simian unlocks the door with a quick *click*. As the door swings open, the paladin takes the lead, activating his *Truesight*.

You see that the torches in this room have all been snuffed out. The rooms here are filled with treasure: chests heaped with coins, polished amphorae, strings of pearls, and ornate pieces of armor. Set into the floor, in front of another set of heavy double doors, is a mosaic tile depicting a frog-like humanoid.

As you enter the threshold, grungs flush out of the darkness with tridents and pitchforks. They jab their tridents out, pointing it straight at all of you.



Wukong's *Ring of 72 Transformations* glow with golden light as he casts *Disguise Self*. Raphael, Salazar, Wukong, Ariadne, Claptrap and Vorn all shapeshift into grungs.

"Move in!" Wukong commands as the Party - now frogs - leap into action.